

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

3D Animation

Make no mistake about it—3D animation is very techy. Essentially, try and convince your audience that you can create a 3D scene. Of course, you'll need to throw in the word "Maya" somewhere.

■ Motion Capture: Be sure to refer to it as "MoCap", which sounds cool. Mention the Gypsy MoCap system. Say, "MoCap saves time. Simple ambient animation is much easier when MoCapped than if the subtleties where animated by hand.

Mocap also easily captures nuances." Remember that the Gypsy system consists of wearing a spaceman-like suit that captures the movements of the wearer.

■ Gait Cycles and Animation Paths: These are basically the sequence of steps that an animated character goes through. Speak as though you know how to manipulate these, using words such as "interpolation": "With motion editing, you can manipulate body angles and smooth transitions between trials that were joined by interpolation. A single gait cycle could be blended with itself to create an endless walk."

■ NURBS: NURBS modelling is advanced stuff. So you say, of course, "Man, NURBS is advanced. The toolsets are too complex." Then you continue: "NURBS are basically ideal curves whose shapes are governed by control vertices. The control vertices do not lie on the curve." Since it really *is* advanced, excuse yourself with, "Well, it's difficult to explain it to you beyond that. You basically have to think about lines and surfaces in a differently—I can't explain it."

And finally, when faced with a tough question such as one about muscle and bone animation, simply refer your audience to the Web, saying, "There's tons of tutorials out there for muscle and bone animation..."

A Distro, A Download, A DVD

Our friends ask us: You guys work at a tech magazine. Bandwidth must be flying, right? Wrong. Ask Ahmed, the guy who downloads stuff for the DVD. This time, we decided to surprise our readers—give them the biggest Linux distro ever on a Digit DVD. We decided to devote 2.3 GB to Fedora Linux, one of the most sought-after Linux distros the world over.

And so with much enthusiasm, Ahmed began the download. Until about 10 minutes passed, and he began his monthly fight with Ajay, Digit's sysadmin, over bandwidth. Ajay, like all sysadmins across the world, has long embraced the endearing quality of the sages of the past—nothing moves him,

nothing affects him. Give him the choicest of swearwords, and like Lord Krishna bearing the thousand insults of the irascible King Shishupal, Ajay stays put and gets on with life.

Other people hoard money; Ajay hoards bandwidth. And Ahmed, who believes in sharing whatever you have, is not amused. He then throws his weight around, increases his decibel level, shakes Ajay out of a

technological reverie, and manages to usurp some amount of bandwidth.

Fedora Linux, dear reader, is a result of this historic showdown between Ahmed and Ajay. Download it right now from the DVD until we sort out the fight for next month's DVD!

DIGIT DIARY

into cyberspace. He asks them to attack US computers with the aim of committing credit card fraud, called "carding". There is even a chapter that provides an outline on how to get started.

"The worry is that an army of people committing cybercrime could raise a great deal of money for other activities that terrorists are carrying out," said Alan Paller, research director of the Sans Institute, a US Internet security training company.

Indonesian police said Samudra's laptop revealed an attempt at carding, but it was "unclear whether he had succeeded". Now here's a man dedicated to his beliefs. Even while on death row.

prison time for those who take photos or videos of people that, without consent, expose underwear-covered body areas.

Hanan B Kolko, a New York civil liberties lawyer, said about the bill, "At least theoretically, there is now federal protection available so people don't unknowingly have their private parts photographed, downloaded and transmitted the world over."

One caveat is that the legislation would only apply in federal jurisdictions, such as Federal buildings, National Parks and Military bases. However, exceptions have been provided for law enforcement, prison work and intelligence.

Lawmakers say that the use of hidden recording devices such as pinhole cameras has been favourite amongst peeping Toms for years, but that the proliferation of tiny cell phones that can take pictures and shoot video has taken the crime out of bedrooms and bathrooms and into public places.

This indicates that camera phones in the US, as in Saudi Arabia, are seen as "spreading obscenity", in a sense. Conviction would mean a fine capped at \$100,000 (Rs 45,00,000) and/or a prison sentence of one year.

STRESSBUSTER

Destroy And Relieve Stress

A Spanish junkyard has come up with a novel post-modern stress therapy offering. For -40 (Rs 3,900), stress-weary people can vent their frustrations on stuff such as cars, computers, and cell phones—modern life's all-pervasive irritants. Naturally, some people like to affix their bosses' photographs on the stuff they are destroying.

At the junkyard in Luvia, 160 kilometres north-east of Madrid, there's plenty of stuff to smash, of course, but the yard also provides the necessary equipment—helmets, sledgehammers, goggles. Heavy metal music is also played while customers do their act as part of "damage therapy" sessions that are being organised by a group called StopStress.

StopStress co-founder Jorge Arribas told *Reuters*, "Some people even bring photos of their bosses and put them on top of the cars before they start hitting them with their hammers."

For the -40, customers are given up to two hours in which to wreck stuff.

LOOK STRAIGHT!

Upskirts And Downblouses Banned

Saudi Arabia banned Scamera phones a while ago. Although the US is not adopting so drastic a measure, there are privacy concerns being raised about the new devices, which have led to the US Congress passing a bill that would levy a heavy fine and/or